CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report

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Introduction

This report is submitted as part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The project scenario places me in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, responsible for helping peers navigate the digital world safely and professionally. To fulfil this role, I completed five tasks covering key digital skills across five course modules.

The tasks include creating a digital literacy awareness infographic, building a professional online presence, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, drafting professional emails, and researching cybercrime. All completed work is organised in a public GitHub repository at github.com/Adikundliya/Digital-Literacy-Project-25BAI10634. This report documents the approach taken in each task, the tools used, and personal reflections on what was learnt.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

A one-page infographic on digital literacy was created using an online design platform. The infographic covered key topics such as digital footprint, cybersecurity practices, and online etiquette. Important concepts like strong password usage, avoiding suspicious links, and responsible online behavior were visually represented.

This task helped in understanding how information can be communicated effectively through visuals. It emphasized simplifying complex concepts into clear and concise points. The process also improved creativity and design skills while reinforcing awareness about safe digital practices. The infographic serves as a quick and effective reference for promoting responsible internet usage.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

For Task 2, I set up professional profiles on three platforms — GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle — with screenshots saved in the task-2-portfolio/ folder.

GitHub is used for hosting and sharing code projects. I created a profile README under the username Adikundliya, which includes my name, branch, year, and a short note on what I hope to learn during my B.Tech. This Digital Literacy repository is already part of my GitHub portfolio. LinkedIn is the leading professional networking platform used by employers and internship coordinators globally. I filled in my Education section with my current degree, institution, and expected graduation year. Kaggle is a data science and machine learning community where students can practise coding and participate in competitions — directly relevant to my Artificial Intelligence branch.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to document all my projects, LinkedIn to build professional connections and apply for internships, and Kaggle to sharpen my machine learning skills alongside coursework. Setting these up in the first semester felt like an important early investment in my digital identity.

Task 3 – Coding Platforms & Google Workspace Collaboration

For Task 3, I explored two categories of tools: a coding practice platform and a cloud collaboration tool. All screenshots and notes are saved in the task-3-platforms/ folder.

For the coding component, I created an account on HackerRank and completed the Python Introduction challenge. HackerRank provides an in-browser code editor with automated test cases, making it easy to practise without any local setup. A screenshot of the completed challenge and score has been saved as proof. For the collaboration component, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms with five questions — including a multiple choice and a short answer question — designed to test batchmates on digital safety and email etiquette. The form is linked to a Google Sheet that tracks responses in real time. The form link will be added to the README before final submission.

HackerRank will help me build consistent coding habits with instant feedback. Google Forms and Sheets are practical for collaborative coursework, surveys, and peer feedback — skills I will need throughout my degree.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

For Task 4, I drafted two professional emails and a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist, all saved in the task-4-email-etiqutte/ folder. The first email was a request from a student to a professor for a deadline extension. The second expressed interest in a summer internship opportunity. Both follow proper email structure: a clear subject line, a formal greeting, a well-organised body, and a professional sign-off. The social media checklist is saved separately as social-media-checklist.md.

One situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem is when students send casual, unstructured emails to professors with no subject line, no greeting, and no context. These are frequently ignored or leave a poor impression. The fix is simple — a clear subject, a formal address, a brief reason, and a polite close. A short, well-written email always scores higher than a long, poorly structured one.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

For Task 5, I researched UPI and Online Payment Fraud — one of the most common cybercrimes affecting college students in India. I wrote a case study saved as casestudy.md covering how this fraud works, who is targeted, and the consequences. I also created a 'Stay Safe Online' checklist saved as prevention-checklist.md, with eight actionable tips including two specific to UPI safety and references to cybercrime.gov.in and Helpline 1930.

What surprised me most was how psychologically sophisticated these scams are. UPI fraud does not involve hacking — it relies entirely on social engineering. Victims are manipulated into approving payment requests while believing they are receiving money. By the time they realise, recovery is nearly impossible. One habit I will

personally change is to never approve a UPI request from an unknown contact, no matter how convincing the story sounds.

Conclusion

This project has been a practical and eye-opening experience. Across five tasks, I developed skills that go well beyond a typical first-semester classroom — from building a professional digital presence on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle, to understanding how cybercriminals psychologically manipulate victims. The most important takeaway is that digital literacy is an ongoing practice, not a one-time task. Communicating professionally, coding consistently, staying alert online, and maintaining credible profiles are habits that will serve me throughout my B.Tech and beyond. I feel genuinely better prepared to navigate the digital world responsibly after completing this project.

References

- GitHub – github.com
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com
- Kaggle – kaggle.com
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930 (24x7, Government of India)
- CSE0001 Digital Literacy – Project Assignment Brief, VIT Bhopal University